Syed-ul-Abrar

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Network and Systems Engineer with 2.5+ years of experience in end-to-end design, deployment, and management of enterprise IT infrastructure. Brings a dual expertise in **network security** (Cisco, Palo Alto, Fortinet) and **systems administration** (Windows Server, Active Directory, Virtualization). Proven ability to ensure optimal performance, security, and reliability across both network and server environments. Seeking to leverage a comprehensive skill set and certifications (CCNP, MCSE) to deliver robust and integrated solutions.

EDUCATION

Hadaf Group of Colleges — **Peshawar, KPK**

FCS (Faculty of Computer Science) Passed with Grade: A1 — *Graduation Date: March 2022*

- Relevant Coursework**:** Computer Networks (TCP/IP protocols, system architecture), Operating Systems, C Programming, and Database Management Systems. Strong foundation in Mathematics including Algebra, Calculus, and Differential Equations.

Bacha Khan University (BKUC) — **Charsadda, KPK**

BSCS (Bachelor of Science in Computer Science) — *Graduation Status: In Progress*

- Course Description: The Bachelor of Science in Computer Science develops strong foundations in mathematics, programming and algorithms, with core knowledge in databases, operating systems, and computer networks. The program also covers information security, distributed systems, and advanced computing concepts, supported by a final year project to build practical problem-solving skills.
- Awards & Honors**:** To be updated as program progresses.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Networking & Routing	***Protocols:*** **OSPF, BGP, EIGRP, RIP, IS-IS** | Concepts: Areas, Route Summarization, Redistribution, Neighbor Relationships.
	Switching: **VLANs** (Voice & Data, Trunking), **VTP** (Pruning, Versions), **STP/RSTP/MSTP** (Root Guard, BPDU Filter).
	DHCP: **Server, Client, Pool/Scope, Relay Agent, Options** (DNS, Gateway), **Lease Time, Snooping, Starvation, Helper Address.**
	EtherChannel: **EtherChannel** (LACP, PAgP), **Port Security, MAC Address Management**.
	WAN: SD-WAN **(Cisco vEdge/vSmart/vBond, Overlay Management Protocol)**, **MPLS (LDP, Layer 3 VPNs) , DMVPN, IPsec**.
	Redundancy: **HSRP** (Preemption, Tracking), **VRRP, GLBP** (Load Balancing, Weighting)
Security & Firewalls	***Palo Alto:*** **App-ID, User-ID, Security Policies, NAT, VPN** (IPsec, Global Protect), **Threat Prevention , URL Filtering, Panorama**.
	FortiGate: **UTM , Firewall Policies, VPN** (SSL/IPsec), **Antivirus, IPS/IDS, Web Filtering, High Availability** (HA) (Active-Passive, Cluster).
	Check Point: **SmartConsole** (Policy Management), **Security Policies, NAT** (Hide/Static), **VPN** (Site-to-Site), **IPS/IDS** (Threat Prevention).
	F5 BIG-IP: **LTM** (Pools, Nodes, Monitors), **SSL Offloading** (Manage Certificate), **iRules , Load Balancing , High Availability**.
Systems & Virtualization	***Windows Server :*** **Active Directory** (AD DS) (Users, Groups, GPOs), **DNS** (Zones, Forwarding**), DHCP** (Scopes, Reservations), **WDS.**
	Windows Client: **Windows 10, 11** (Deployment (MDT), **Security** (BitLocker), **Group Policy, Troubleshooting** (Event Viewer)) ,**logging**.
	Linux: **Ubuntu, CentOS, Red Hat** (System Administration, **Shell Scripting** (Bash), **Package Management** (apt, yum), **Service Managers.**
	Virtualization: **VMware vSphere/ESXi** (vCenter, VM Management), **Hyper-V** (Clustering, Live Migration), **High Availability** (HA),
	Wireless: **WLAN Controllers** (Cisco WLC), **Access Points** (Cisco, Ubiquiti, Aruba), **Security** (WPA2/WPA3, 802.1X), **, RF, DHCP**.
Other Technologies	***Monitoring & CCTV:*** **DVR/NVR Configuration, IP Cameras** (ONVIF, PTZ), **System Setup, Motion Detection, Remote Viewing.**
	Vendors: **Cisco| Huawei| Juniper | PTCL |Ubiquiti | Aruba |Tenda | Microtik | Cisco ASA.**
Scripting	***Programming:*** **Python** (Intermediate) (Automation, Scripting), **C++** (Intermediate), **Bash** (Shell Scripting).

EXPERIENCE

HIMS (Hafeez Institute of Medical Sciences) — **Peshawar, KPK**

IT Support Engineer — *June 2022 – October 2023*

- Deployed and optimized a campus-wide wireless network of 10+ Ubiquiti access points and controllers, providing reliable, high-density connectivity for over 500 students and faculty and enabling digital learning tools.
- Built and maintained a dedicated computer lab environment used for practical training by 100+ students, directly supporting key needs.
- Integrated wireless and wired network infrastructures, implementing basic security policies on APs that reduced unauthorized access.
- Streamlined IT support by configuring and troubleshooting multi-function printers and peripheral devices.

INARA SYSTEMS — **Peshawar, KPK**

Network and System Engineer — *February 2024 – June 2024*

- Architected and implemented a new VLAN segmentation strategy across Cisco switches, utilizing VTP and STP to eliminate broadcast storms and enhance network security and performance for 150+ users.
- Engineered and deployed complex routing solutions using OSPF and BGP on Cisco routers (2600/2800/3600/3700 series), implementing NAT and ACL policies that improved secure internet accessibility and optimized inter-departmental traffic flow.
- Virtualized and migrated 6+ physical servers to a Microsoft Hyper-V environment, consolidating hardware resources by 40%.
- Administered and secured the core Windows Server infrastructure (2008R2-2022), including Active Directory, DNS, and DHCP services, maintaining 99.9% uptime for critical identity and authentication services.
- Provided Tier 3 technical support, resolving critical escalation tickets 25% faster than the team average through methodical troubleshooting of complex network and system issues.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & TRAINING

- **CCNP (Routing & Switching)** Advanced Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (Corelinks Int'l, Peshawar)
- **CCNP Security** Advanced Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (Corelinks Int'l, Peshawar)
- **Fortinet NSE 4** Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (Corelinks int'l, Peshawar)
- **Palo Alto Networks** (PCNSE) Engineering Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (CBT Nuggets Training)
- **VMware vSphere** Technical Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (Udemy)
- **Microsoft MCSE** Core Infrastructure Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (Corelinks Int'l, Peshawar)
- **Linux System Administration** Training - Completed full syllabus with hands-on labs (Udemy)

LANGUAGES

- Pashto: Native
- Urdu: Fluent
- English: Fluent (Professional Proficiency; used for technical documentation and collaboration in international team environments)

HOBBIES / INTRESETS

- Offensive Security Practice: Honing analytical and problem-solving skills through hands-on ethical hacking labs.
- Technical Innovation: Exploring emerging technologies and prototyping new solutions to complex IT problems.
- Boxing: Cultivating discipline, resilience, and stress management through rigorous physical training.
- Continual Learning: Dedicated to expanding knowledge through literature and acquiring new languages.